

## Can you feel my *heartbeat*, baby?

The Food and Drug Administration in the US has approved a new type of pacemaker capable of sending cardiac information via remote transmission. The first of its kind, Biotronik's Home System can help doctors monitor a



patient's condition between office visits. A short-range radio frequency transmitter sends data to a cell phone-like device that patients carry with them. The phone transmits the information to a company service centre, which correlates the data and sends it to the patient's physician.

## quicktake

Govind Misir, chairman and CEO, SLMSOFT.com, talks about the company's e-commerce products

### ▲ What is SLMSOFT.com?

It is a leading Canadian global provider of electronic financial transaction solutions for the e-commerce market. We provide e-commerce tools and transaction management products and services.

### ▲ What is SLMSOFT's plan for India in the long run?

We plan to take Design Expo's revenues to \$5 million from \$1.9 million in the next 12 months. The first task is to enhance our existing products through R&D.

### ▲ What other technology solutions is SLMSOFT introducing?

Our end-to-end transaction management solution, ESP-Link, empowers over 1,100 cus-



Govind Misir  
Chairman and CEO  
SLMSOFT.com Inc

tomers in 55 countries. Financial institutions, retailers, government agencies and healthcare providers benefit from the

breadth and convenience of SLMSOFT.com's electronic banking and online transaction systems, enabling them to build rewarding relationships with their customers and thrive in today's wired marketplace.

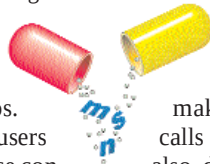
### ▲ What are the voice recognition solutions you are planning to introduce in India?

Right now, we are working on different e-transaction products like Smart Cards, and the new products might use new technologies such as voice recognition solutions to enhance user-friendliness, efficiency and effectiveness of particular products.

## And now MSN with vitamins!

Windows XP's messaging technology will undergo cosmetic changes, allowing a full range of emoticons, from the traditional smiley faces to cats and coffee cups. Windows Messenger users will be able to organise contacts by groups. Microsoft has also increased the number of contacts accepted by the messaging client from 75 to 150.

Microsoft has signed on



Call Serve, Deltathree, Dialpad Communications, Net2Phone and Telus to offer people equipped with Windows Messenger, the ability to make Net-based phone calls over their PCs. It has also decided to collaborate with Groove Networks. These services will also be added to MSN Messenger, which will be available for download with the XP messaging client.

## Agile in a Crisis, Robots shows their mettle

Robots are proving their mettle at the WTC blast zone. Their immunity to fatigue means they can work longer than even the most dedicated rescue worker. Some of the robots are small and compact enough to go down sewage pipes that are less than a foot in diameter. Others can flatten

themselves to squeeze through tight spaces or position themselves upright to look over objects. Some have infrared cameras and all have video cameras, with images sent to rescue workers on the surface through a cable or wirelessly.

Most of the robots are experimental prototypes.

## Redalert

### KaZaA, the virus desktop

KaZaA, a file swapping application, that is number three on CNET for most popular downloads, is quite likely to infect your PC with a virus. In fact, 6 per cent of all music downloaded from KaZaA is not music at all, but a virus. Due to poor filtering, a file like 'I hate celine dion.mp3.vbs' would be displayed as 'I hate celine dion.mp3' without displaying the .vbs extension. Viruses can be disguised as videos, images and executables in a similar fashion.

The FAQ for KaZaA says "Not all file types can contain viruses or Trojans. Music, video, and picture files are generally safe—that includes files with the extensions .mp3, .wav, .mpg, .avi, .mov, .bmp and .jpg. PDF documents (.pdf) and text files (.txt) are also generally safe. You should be cautious of executable files (.exe) and Microsoft Word and Excel documents (.doc and .xls). These files are specified with an icon in the search results on KaZaA.com."

### BackdoorSlackbot.B

Backdoor.Slackbot.B is a backdoor Trojan that allows a hacker to control your computer using Internet Relay Chat (IRC). It can update itself by checking for newer versions over the Internet. This backdoor Trojan contains its own IRC client, which allows it to connect to an IRC channel coded into it by its creator.

Use updated anti-virus software to delete all files detected as Backdoor.Slackbot.B and remove the value that it adds to the registry.



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